

IMAGE EDITING

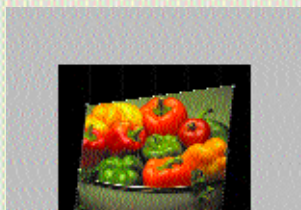
Crop them, skew them, play with them. Give your images the perfect look

Image modes: RGB, CMYK, Duotone, Tritone

Before you begin editing an image, save it in the correct mode, else it won't show accurate colours. If you are going to use the image on the Web, save it in RGB mode; for print, save it in CMYK. You can also save the image as Duotone (two colours) or Tritone (three colours)—these modes impart interesting effects to an image. If you want to use an image for the Web as well as for print, make sure that you have two copies, one RGB and the other CMYK.

Perspective in cropped images

The Cropping tool offers a wide range of options. For instance, you can skew the cropped image by selecting Perspective in the Options bar. You can even resize the cropped image by expanding the cropping edges beyond the



The Perspective option lets you skew cropped images

image size. Use the [Alt] key to maintain the centre and the borders when you click and drag the mouse. Use [Shift] to maintain the proportions.

Removing noise from digital camera images

Images taken from a digital camera show noise when opened in Photoshop, usually in the Blue channel. To correct this, go to the Channels palette and make the Blue channel active. Now click Gaussian Blur (**Filter > Blur**) and add a slight blur to the image—start with 0.5 and increase the blur by using the Up Arrow key. When the noise has pretty much disappeared, click on the RGB composite channel and continue with the regular image correction.

Fixing stray pixels

Many a times when we use Magic Wand or Color Range, Photoshop leaves some stray pixels unselected. To select these, under **Select > Modify > Smooth**, enter a sample radius of 1 pixel and click OK.

Making a dull image brighter and sharper

Need to make a low-resolution image sharper and brighter? Duplicate the layer which has your image and under the Filter menu, choose **Filter > Other > High Pass**. In the example shown here, the radius is set to 2 (choose the radius according to the resolution of the image). Now in the Layer's palette, choose the Hard Light option under Blend Modes. You could further flatten the image by choosing



A low resolution image



The low resolution image after brightening and sharpening

Layer > Flatten Image and see the difference between the new and the original image!

Working with the Healing Brush and Patch tool

With the old Rubber Stamp tool, you can clone pixels from a sampled area and apply them to an area needing correction. However, it does not take care of the shadows and highlights of the flawed area. The new Healing Brush tool in Photoshop 7 clones by using the texture from the sampled area and then using the colours around the brush stroke as you paint over the flaw. You can sample and heal between two images but you need to make sure they are in the same mode.

The Patch tool is similar to the Healing Brush but instead of painting with brush strokes, you select the flawed area and apply the patch to it. It can be useful for selecting larger flawed areas.



Patch

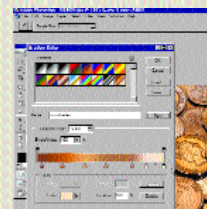
When working with the Patch tool, you make your initial selection with this tool. Instead of dragging the selection with the Patch tool to the position you want to clone, and then release your mouse

Creating gradient photos

Seen a nice combination of background somewhat neat little trick will show you can use it on your own creation. Open a new document and select the Gradient tool. In the Gradient Options bar, click on the Gradient bar. Now move the cursor outside the Gradient bar. Now click on the first color swatch on the Gradient bar. Now click on the first color swatch on the Gradient bar.



The original photograph



The gradient created from the photograph